



women already had a better record, having been in two finals before this magnificent triumph.

Just as the '83 win galvanised Indian cricket and gave it a voice that was heard around the world, this victory will make the countries that started women's cricket long before India did realise that their era of domination has been shaken.

The '83 win also encouraged parents of aspiring cricketers to let their children take up the game. The IPL took it to another level, of course, and that's why today's Indian men's team includes players not just from the metros but from across the country.

Similarly, this win will give new wings to

Red-letter day: India beat South Africa by 52 runs to win the Women's ODI World Cup for the first time. EMMANUAL YOGINI

women's cricket, bringing more girls into the game from the remotest parts of India. The WPL has already begun that process, as parents now see the sport as a genuine career option for their daughters and are more willing to support them.

This is a win to savour, a win to cherish, a win for the ages. Well done, Harmanpreet Kaur and the girls. You have made the country proud — may this be the first of many trophies to come to India.



This title win proves that it will invariably be Indian coaches who get the best results since they know the players — their strengths, weaknesses, and temperament — and understand the nuances of Indian cricket better than any foreigner, however accomplished he or she may be.